

Tuesday, 30 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

22° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

21° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

21° 15°

GLASGOW

Heavy rain

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Great news for the NHS, as resident doctors in England have finally accepted a new pay deal, bringing an end to their long-running strikes.

This three-year dispute has caused significant disruption with multiple rounds of industrial action. The agreement should now see an end to that uncertainty.

HEALTH · UK

2

A new vision for how the UK could be run has been put forward by Andy Burnham, dubbed 'Manchesterism'.

His speech outlined a different approach to the country's economic future. While it's not a full plan yet, it certainly offers some food for thought.

POLITICS · UK

3

Major job losses are on the cards at British American Tobacco, with the company set to cut 9,000 positions.

Earlier this year, the firm announced plans to make savings and become more focused on digital and AI. This move is part of that restructuring.

BUSINESS · UK

4

A body has been found in the search for a 15-year-old boy who went missing after getting into difficulty in a river.

The teenager was last seen struggling in the water at a country park in Greater Manchester. It's a truly heartbreaking development.

TRAGEDY · UK

5

A man is due in court today, charged with attempted murder after a car reportedly hit pedestrians in west London.

The incident happened in Ealing on Saturday, and the man has been remanded in custody. It's a serious case that will now go through the courts.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The Dallas Cowboys Cheerleaders are opening up about their new-found fame as their Netflix show returns.**

The squad is discussing the pressure and excitement that comes with being in the spotlight. They're also talking about World Cup fever!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Dallas Cowboys Cheerleaders? What do you think of their show?

TV · NOW
- 2 Bad Bunny made history in London, becoming the first Latin artist to headline a UK stadium show.**

The Puerto Rican superstar lit up the capital with a vibrant and celebratory performance. Fans enjoyed an incredible party atmosphere.

ON AIR – Did you manage to get tickets for Bad Bunny's historic London show?

MUSIC · WEEKEND
- 3 Comedy fans, listen up! The contents of Alan Carr's castle are going up for sale, because he doesn't want them!**

The sale includes dozens of unique items, from a 'concrete menagerie' of animals to various figures and rural scenes. It sounds like quite the collection!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual item you've ever bought at an auction or car boot sale?

CELEBRITY · SOON
- 4 Could Canada be joining the Eurovision Song Contest? It's a real possibility!**

Prime Minister Mark Carney raised the idea in his 2025 budget. Imagine Canada competing for the Eurovision crown!

ON AIR – Would you like to see Canada join Eurovision? Who would they send?

MUSIC · FUTURE
- 5 Madonna's recent interview with Graham Norton was full of revelations, including a big hint about Glastonbury.**

She also admitted to being 'jealous of Kylie' at one point in her career. It sounds like a fascinating chat!

ON AIR – What's your favourite Madonna song of all time?

MUSIC · RECENT

On the schedule

1 It was a disappointing start for British tennis hopes at Wimbledon yesterday, with six Britons losing on the first day.

Cameron Norrie suffered a shock first-round upset, which was a tough blow. Hopefully, fortunes will turn around for the remaining British players.

ON AIR – Were you watching Wimbledon yesterday? What do you think went wrong for Norrie?

TENNIS · UK

2 England's cricketers have suffered a series defeat, losing to New Zealand by 160 runs in the third Test.

This was Ben Stokes' final game in international cricket, and New Zealand sealed a 2-1 series victory. It's a tough end for England.

ON AIR – What are your thoughts on Ben Stokes' retirement from international cricket?

CRICKET · UK

3 Manchester City has chosen Enzo Maresca as Pep Guardiola's successor, but why him?

City fans will be keen to know what to expect from the Italian. He's agreed to pay compensation to Chelsea to make the move.

ON AIR – Are you a Man City fan? What do you think of the new manager choice?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 Co-hosts Canada are through to the last 16 of the World Cup for the very first time!

Stephen Eustaquio scored a dramatic winner in injury time against South Africa. What a moment for Canadian football!

ON AIR – Which country are you supporting in the World Cup this year?

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL

5 Norway's Viktor Hovland has won the Travelers play-off, beating world number one Scottie Scheffler.

Hovland was cheered on by World Cup fans as he secured the victory. It was an exciting finish on the golf course.

ON AIR – Do you follow golf? Who is your favourite player to watch?

GOLF · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are finding joy in the therapeutic benefits of 'no-dig' gardening techniques.**
This method, which involves layering organic matter on top of soil rather than turning it over, is proving popular for its ease and the healthy soil it creates, attracting more wildlife too.
- 2 A surge in interest for 'heritage crafts' is seeing old skills being revived across the country.**
From basket weaving to blacksmithing, people are keen to learn traditional techniques, often attending workshops and classes to master these timeless arts.
- 3 The simple act of 'cloud gazing' is being championed as a mindful way to relax and de-stress.**
Taking a few moments to watch the ever-changing shapes in the sky can provide a wonderful break from screens and a chance to quietly reflect.
- 4 Local 'book-sharing schemes' are fostering community spirit in neighbourhoods.**
Little free libraries and book swap boxes are popping up, encouraging neighbours to share their favourite reads and discover new authors without cost.
- 5 More people are embracing the charm of 'upcycled furniture' for their homes.**
Giving old pieces a new lease of life with a lick of paint or creative touches is not only sustainable but also adds unique character to any room.
- 6 Researchers are noting a trend towards 'conscious consumption' when it comes to everyday purchases.**
Shoppers are increasingly looking at the origin and environmental impact of products, favouring brands that align with their values and offer longevity.
- 7 The delight of 'picnic planning' is bringing families and friends together for outdoor fun.**
From selecting the perfect spot to preparing delicious treats, the anticipation of a good picnic is proving just as enjoyable as the meal itself.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with the remote control, even when we're the only one watching?

ANSWER: TALKING TO IT AS IF IT UNDERSTANDS OUR COMMANDS.

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'food combination' that others find a bit strange, but we absolutely love. What is it?

ANSWER: JAM ON A CHEESE SANDWICH.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little bits of kit' around the house that we genuinely couldn't do without, don't we?**
Perhaps it's a specific kitchen gadget, a trusty tool, or even just a particular mug. What's the one household item you absolutely couldn't live without?

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new hot drink' that isn't tea or coffee, and it becomes your new favourite?**
Maybe it's a spiced chai, a rich hot chocolate, or a herbal infusion. What's your go-to alternative hot drink when you fancy a change from the usual brew?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called a 'prickle'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive sound of a breaking whip actually comes from its tip moving faster than the speed of sound, creating a small sonic boom.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, with scientists observing them at altitudes of over 9,000 metres (30,000 feet).
- The 'king of fruits', Durian, is banned on public transport in some Asian countries due to its incredibly strong and distinctive odour.
- A newborn panda cub is smaller than a typical stick of butter, weighing around 100 grams.
- The human nose can detect over one trillion different scents, far more than previously thought.
- Greenland is the world's largest island, covering an area of over 2.1 million square kilometres.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, fought between Britain and Zanzibar on 27 August 1896.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.

On this day

Day 181 of the year, 184 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Erentrude; Christian feast day: St. Paul the Apostle (solo feast day); Christian feast day: St. Mary of Jerusalem, mother of Apostle Mark the Evangelist first Bishop of Alexandria and Byblos; Christian feast day: St. Martial. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1933 — M. J. K. Smith, English cricketer and rugby player
- 1938 — Jeri Taylor, American screenwriter (died 2024)
- 1968 — Phil Anselmo, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1956 — David Alan Grier, American actor, singer, and comedian
- 1943 — Florence Ballard, American pop/soul singer (died 1976)
- 1959 — Brendan Perry, English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1954 — Stephen Barlow, English organist, composer, and conductor
- 1940 — Mark Spoelstra, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2007)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1986 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules in *Bowers v. Hardwick* that states can outlaw homosexual acts between consenting adults.
- 1993 — Malta is officially subdivided into 68 local councils by the Local Councils Act.
- 2015 — A Hercules C-130 military aircraft with 113 people on board crashes in a residential area in Medan, Indonesia, resulting in at least 116 deaths.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2007 — A Jeep Cherokee filled with propane canisters drives into the entrance of Glasgow Airport, Scotland in a failed terrorist attack. This was linked to the 2007 London car bombs that had taken place the day before.
- 1974 — The Baltimore municipal strike of 1974 begins.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1966 — The National Organization for Women, the United States' largest feminist organization, is founded.
- 1953 — The first Chevrolet Corvette rolls off the assembly line in Flint, Michigan.

- 1968 — Pope Paul VI issues the Credo of the People of God.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 182 of the year, 183 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Catholic Church and Syriac Christianity); Christian feast day: Blessed Antonio Rosmini-Serbat; Christian feast day: Junípero Serra; Christian feast day: Julius and Aaron. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1951 — Fred Schneider, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 1989 — Hannah Murray, English actress
- 1969 — Séamus Egan, American-Irish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1998 — Chloe Bailey, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1951 — Victor Willis, American singer-songwriter, pianist and actor
- 1935 — David Prowse, English actor (died 2020)
- 1962 — Andre Braugher, American actor (died 2023)
- 1945 — Debbie Harry, American singer-songwriter and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1972 — The first Gay pride march in England takes place.
- 2002 — The International Criminal Court is established to prosecute individuals for genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and the crime of aggression.
- 2013 — Croatia becomes the 28th member of the European Union.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2006 — The first operation of Qinghai–Tibet Railway is conducted in China.
- 1984 — The PG-13 rating is introduced by the MPAA.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)